



LEAD TO LEAVE · THE 1:1 LOOP

The 1:1 LOOP

GUIDE & WORKSHEET

The most important meeting leaders often miss — the one-on-one. These resources create better connections, foster valuable conversations, and establish consistent rhythms and commitments from leader to employee.

Staying in the L.O.O.P. is how you take an operation to the next level.

The L.O.O.P.

Every 1:1 runs the same four stops — in order. Land, then Obstacles, then Opportunities, then Plan.

L Land

Ground the conversation in the human, not the task. Before diving into work, check in on energy and wellbeing — so the person feels seen, and so you know what state they're actually in.

O Obstacles

Clear what's blocking progress. This is where you lead: remove friction and reprioritize before small blockers become big problems.

O Opportunities

Where development, feedback, and career growth live. Look forward — turn a routine check-in into a coaching moment.

P Plan

Plan closes the loop. Both people leave with explicit ownership of next steps, so the conversation turns into action before the next meeting.

Run it 70/30 — they talk about seventy percent of the time. The associate owns the agenda; you own the questions.

Manager Question Bank

Pick 1-2 questions per stop — you don't need them all. Follow the energy, and listen more than you talk.

L LAND — Arrive as humans

FOCUS: CONNECTION & WELLBEING

- Before we touch work — how are you, really?
- What's taken the most energy out of you lately, in or out of work?
- On a scale of running-on-empty to fully-charged, where are you today — and why?
- What's one thing you're looking forward to right now?
- Is anything going on I should know about so I can support you better?

O OBSTACLES — Clear the road ahead

FOCUS: PRIORITIES, BLOCKERS, SUPPORT

- What are you focused on this week, and what's getting in the way?
- Where are you stuck, or waiting on a decision from someone else?
- What's one thing I could remove, decide, or unblock to make your week easier?
- Which priority or expectation feels fuzziest to you right now?
- If nothing changes, what's most likely to slip — and what would help?

O OPPORTUNITIES — Grow forward

FOCUS: FEEDBACK, DEVELOPMENT, CAREER

- What's a skill you want to build, and where could you practice it next?
- Looking back on the last few weeks — what are you proud of, and what would you do differently?
- What feedback do you have for me, or for how I'm managing you?
- Where do you want to be in a year, and what's one step we could take toward it now?
- What work lately has felt most like “you” — energizing and a good fit?

P PLAN — Lock the next loop

FOCUS: COMMITMENTS & OWNERSHIP

- What are our top two or three takeaways, and who owns each?
- What will you do before we next meet — and what will I?
- What does “done” look like for the things we just agreed on?
- Did we miss anything important you wanted to cover?
- Was this 1:1 useful — what would make the next one better?

Remember: the associate owns the agenda. These are prompts, not a script — the best 1:1 is the one where they talk most.

Associate Question Bank

Plan before your 1:1 and jot a few notes. Walking in prepared means the time goes where it matters to you.

L LAND — Arrive as humans

FOCUS: CONNECTION & WELLBEING

- How am I actually doing right now — energy, mood, workload?
- What drained me most lately, and what lifted me?
- Where am I on a relative energy scale today, and why? (1–10)
- What am I looking forward to?
- Is there anything, work or personal, my manager should know to support me?

O OBSTACLES — Clear the road ahead

FOCUS: PRIORITIES, BLOCKERS, SUPPORT

- What are my top priorities this week, and which one is at risk?
- Where am I stuck or waiting on a decision?
- What's the one thing I most need from my manager to move faster?
- Which goal or expectation do I want made clearer?
- What might slip — and what's my plan or ask to prevent it?

O OPPORTUNITIES — Grow forward

FOCUS: FEEDBACK, DEVELOPMENT, CAREER

- What skill do I want to grow, and what would help me practice it?
- What am I proud of recently, and what would I do differently?
- What honest feedback do I have for my manager?
- Where do I want to grow in the next 6–12 months, and what's the first step?
- What work energizes me most? How do I get more of it?

P PLAN — Lock the next loop

FOCUS: COMMITMENTS & OWNERSHIP

- What are the two or three things I'll commit to before our next 1:1?
- What did I ask my manager to own?
- What didn't we talk about last time that's important today?
- What does success look like for my action items?
- What would make our next 1:1 more useful for me?

Remember: this is your meeting. Bring what matters to you; your manager is here to listen and unblock.

Manager 1:1 Planner

ASSOCIATE	DATE	NEXT 1:1
🔗 SINCE LAST TIME — CLOSE THE PREVIOUS LOOP		
COMMITMENTS I OWNED — DONE?	WHAT THEY COMMITTED TO	
L · LAND — CONNECTION & WELLBEING NOTES		
O · OBSTACLES — THEIR TOP PRIORITIES (1-3)	BLOCKERS + WHAT I'LL UNBLOCK	
O · OPPORTUNITIES — GROWTH FOCUS / FEEDBACK I'LL GIVE	FEEDBACK I HEARD FROM THEM	
P · PLAN — THEIR COMMITMENTS (WHO / WHAT / BY WHEN)	MY COMMITMENTS (WHO / WHAT / BY WHEN)	
★ Celebrate — name one win out loud before you close.		

Associate 1:1 Prep Sheet

MY NAME	MANAGER	DATE
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🔄 SINCE LAST TIME — CLOSE THE PREVIOUS LOOP

WHAT I COMMITTED TO — STATUS	WHAT I'M STILL WAITING ON

L · LAND — HOW I'M DOING THIS WEEK

O · OBSTACLES — MY TOP PRIORITIES (1-3)	WHERE I'M STUCK + WHAT I NEED

O · OPPORTUNITIES — A SKILL I'M BUILDING / A RECENT WIN	FEEDBACK I HAVE FOR MY MANAGER

P · PLAN — WHAT I'LL COMMIT TO (WHO / WHAT / BY WHEN)	WHAT I'M ASKING MY MANAGER TO OWN

★ *My one thing — don't leave without it.*